DAYMOND JOHN

PERFECTING *Your* PITCH

DAYMOND JOHN'S
LAUNCH
ACADEMY

Education

"The only thing more expensive than education is ignorance.

My advice would be to learn as much as you can about your industry immediately. **Become an expert in that industry**. Obviously, there are plenty of resources out there between your library and the Internet, but also try to find a mentor who directly answers your questions. Any information is always good information."

The Market

It all starts with understanding the market. Daymond always asks a basic and timeless question:

"How is this product different than anything else in the marketplace?"

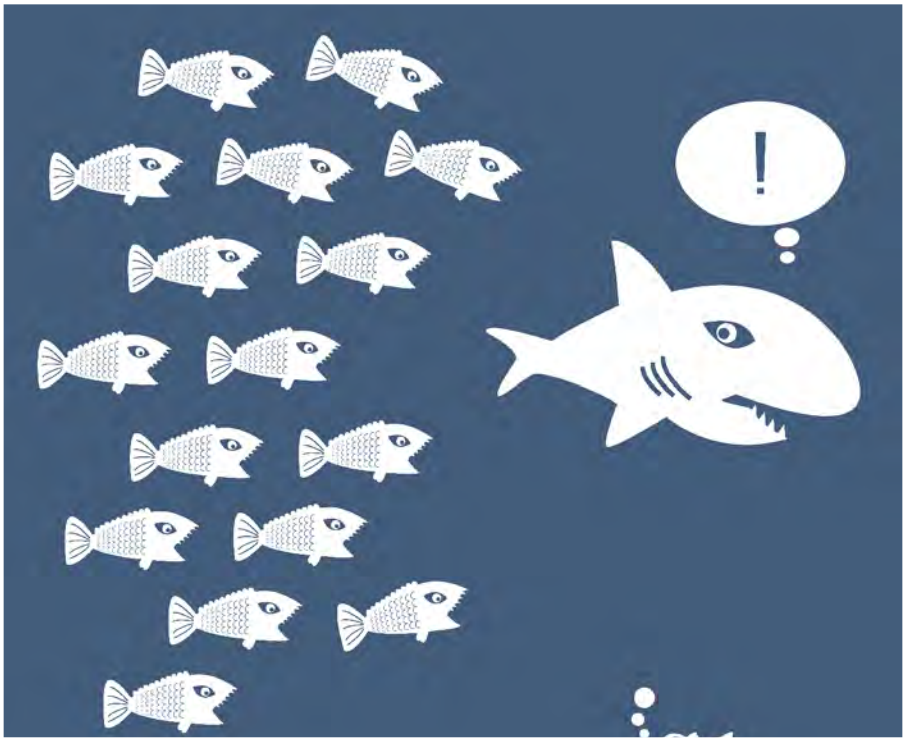
Investors want to know that your product will be able to attract consumers, so know what you are selling.

- Are you selling status?
- Are you fixing a problem?
- Are you making life better?

You don't have to start with a nationwide marketing blitz. Go ahead and start small. **Take the time to learn** how people find out about your product, what marketing works, how people decide to buy, and whether they decide to buy again.

Adapting

"Don't be in such a hurry to grow your brand. Learn what not to do while your business or product is small. Make sure that you and the market can sustain any bumps that may occur down the road. "



You can make mistakes. Be willing to pivot and adjust. Change the interface, add a feature, or change fabrics. See what works so you have a great story to tell when it’s time to go big.

Get Help

A lesson many entrepreneurs learn the hard way is that they can't always do it on their own. If you are running your business as an extension of a hobby you may be able to keep up. Anything larger requires help. This help can be in the form of a partner with a complimentary skill or another company that can provide the service.

Manufacturing the product yourself becomes impossible at some level of sales. So find a manufacturing partner that can provide the quality, speed, and pricing that you need.

"It's the basic lesson of starting a company: **If you don't know how to do something, find someone who does**. I could not have done this alone, whether it was by having the knowledge or financing it myself."

Confidence

Know your own business so that you can be confident in your pitch. As a business owner you need to have a business concept that will move you to sales. **You need to be able to explain your business in just a few sentences.** If it takes you ten minutes to explain your business then you don't really understand it.

Remember, you only need to convey the idea of your business in the first few moments. You want whomever you are pitching to have a "wow" moment and start believing in you and the product. Then the detailed questions and answers can be reviewed.

Know Your Business

You don't have to know everything perfectly at the beginning. If you look at this as a checklist to be perfectly completed you may never start.

Looking at these concepts as a pathway to a successful business will help you answer your own questions and quiet your own doubts.

"Don't wait for the perfect time; you will wait forever. Always take advantage of the time that you're given and make it perfect for you."

Concepts

Your Product – This is your first concept of what your product is.

Your Passion – Why is this product important to you? What sacrifice are you willing to make?

Customer Why – Why does the customer want or need the product? What are you solving for them?

Product Prototype – Do you need to show the product before going into production?

Sales - How and where will you sell the product?

Customer Research – How do you find customers? Who are they influenced by? How do they make decisions?

Product Value – How does the customer value the product in relation to features and cost?

Concepts II

Product Cost – How much does it cost to make the product now and in the future?

Product Brand – How will you use your brand to promote the product or lifestyle?

Marketing – What is the best way to get the word out about your product?

Source and Use of Funds – How much funding will you need? How do you turn funds into profits?

Human and Corporate Resources – What support do you need? Do you need employees? Can you get another group to do certain services for you?

Product Validation – Do you know if your customer is satisfied? Is the product doing what you want it to or do you need to pivot?

Launch Prep

Every investor is different and will be looking for different things in your pitch. Some will focus on the numbers, some will focus on you, and some will focus on how they can help you. **All investors will want to know how you can make them money** by investing in you and your company.

After measuring and individual Daymond focuses on:

- What void in the marketplace does this product fill?
- Who are the core consumers?
- Has this company correctly marketed to them?
- What are the sales?
- What are the distribution channels?
- How well does this person know his industry? (HUGE pet peeve if he doesn't know it.)
- Is the business on an upswing? Or has it peaked?
- Is there room for profit and growth?

What Do You Need?

Do you need more than money? Will your business grow faster if you have a partner with connections? How much ownership can you give up and still be better off if you partner with the right person?

Part of the pitch is to show that you know value. Ask for too little and it shows that you don't know how to value yourself or that you lack confidence in yourself. Ask for too much and it may show that you aren't willing to put your all into the business. **Ask for what you need.** If you need $250,000 to buy inventory and can show that you have the demand to turn it into profit – then ask for it.

Expectations

Be confident in yourself and what you are doing. If you aren't confident then ask yourself why. Remember that **fears can be overcome** with education and a mentor. Then go forward and make it happen.

"Don't be confused and think that you can pitch somebody in eight minutes and they're like, 'Here's a million dollars.' **It's really not like that**. And it's our own money. People think for some reason it's the show's money. If it were the show's money, I'd be giving everybody a million dollars.

I got turned down by 27 banks – and **bankers are nice compared to the sharks**."

Learn

Hold for marketing action